

REVIEW



A Church Teaches Boys How To Be Men

WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



The Rise of American Rosés OFF DUTY

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **U.S. stocks delivered** their best month since late 2023. The S&P 500 rose more than 6% in May, while the Dow added 3.9% and the Nasdaq was 9.6% higher. **A1**

◆ **U.S. District Judge Amit Mehta** questioned how far he should go to limit Google's monopoly in internet search, including putting curbs on how it competes in AI. **B9**

◆ **Deere is considering** a reshuffle of its production among existing factories globally and weighing price increases as it aims to offset costs from the Trump administration's new tariffs. **B9**

◆ **HSBC is disbanding** a division that serves small and medium-size companies in the U.S., part of a broader drive to focus on markets where it has an edge. **B10**

◆ **The Fed's preferred** gauge of consumer prices ticked up slightly in April, lowering the 12-month inflation rate. **A6**

◆ **EOG Resources has** agreed to buy Encino Acquisition Partners for \$5.6 billion, extending its acreage in Ohio's Utica Shale. **B10**

◆ **Ray-Ban maker Essilor-Luxottica** said it would acquire AI-focused ophthalmology platform Optegra from MidEuropa, as part of the group's medical technology strategy. **B10**

World-Wide

◆ **A U.S.-China trade** detente was at risk of falling apart, as Beijing's decision to slow-walk rare-earth exports fueled recriminations from Washington that China is renegeing on the deal to de-escalate the tariff war. **A1**

◆ **Trump said** he would double tariffs on imported steel, a move he said would bolster the domestic industry and protect U.S. jobs. **A2**

◆ **The Supreme Court** will allow the Trump administration to revoke temporary protections allowing about 500,000 migrants from Cuba, Haiti, Nicaragua, and Venezuela to temporarily live and work in the U.S. **A4**

◆ **The FBI** is investigating an effort to impersonate White House chief of staff Susie Wiles, after an individual reached out to Republicans pretending to be her. **A3**

◆ **A Defense Intelligence Agency** employee was charged with attempting to pass classified intelligence to a foreign government. **A4**

◆ **Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth** vowed that the U.S. would come to the defense of Taiwan should China seek to "conquer" the island. **A8**

◆ **The U.S. has presented** Israel and Hamas with a new proposal to pause the fighting in the Gaza Strip, though the militant group has criticized it for not requiring an end to the conflict. **A8**

OPINION

Hearings needed for Biden coverup **A13**

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Elon Musk shook President Trump's hand Friday during an event in the Oval Office to mark the end of Musk's four-month tenure leading the Department of Government Efficiency, which had promised to slash government spending.

Inside the Complicated Ties Between Trump and Musk

WASHINGTON—President Trump recently posed an evocative question to his advisers

By Josh Dawsey, Annie Linskey and Dana Mattioli

about billionaire Elon Musk's promise to slash \$1 trillion in government spending. "Was it all bullshit?" Trump asked, according to administration officials, questioning whether Musk could have ever come close to the cuts he promised to carry out

through the Department of Government Efficiency. The episode captured the flashes of skepticism and frustration from Trump and his senior aides over Musk's rocky four-month tenure in the government, with spats spilling out in the Middle East, cabinet meetings and occasionally in the Oval Office, people familiar with the matter said. And they reflected the broader exasperation over roadblocks that have slowed Musk's efforts, from court challenges to bureaucratic delays.

Despite his frustrations, Trump continues to maintain a fondness for Musk and plans to see him in the future. (They had dinner recently.) He asked aides to organize a friendly farewell on Friday in the Oval Office, where the two heaped praise on one another. The relationship—for a time—had been among the most consequential in modern U.S. politics. Musk spent hundreds of millions of dollars to get Trump elected, helping clinch his return to the White House. And Trump gave Musk

unprecedented access to the government, granting him far-reaching authority over the vast federal bureaucracy on the promise that he could reshape it. Musk's defenders said the billionaire made changes across the government—from slashing foreign aid to cutting the size of the workforce—that likely wouldn't have been carried out without his fierce commitment to DOGE. Trump learned about the timing of Musk's departure in

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China Trade Detente Teeters

Beijing's stalling on rare-earth exports spurs U.S. charge that truce is violated

A U.S.-China trade detente was at risk of falling apart Friday, as Beijing's decision to slow-walk rare-earth exports fueled recriminations from Washington that China is renegeing on the deal to de-escalate the tariff war.

By Lingling Wei, Gavin Bade and Brian Schwartz

Beijing has held up approvals for export licenses for rare earths and other elements needed to make cars, chips and other products, sparking outrage on Friday from President Trump. China's decision to stall on rare earths, according to people familiar with the matter, was in response to the U.S. Commerce Department's May 13 warning against the use of Huawei Technologies' Ascend artificial-intelligence chips "anywhere in the world." "China, perhaps not surprisingly to some, HAS TOTALLY VIOLATED ITS AGREEMENT WITH US," Trump wrote on his social-media platform on Friday. Please turn to page A6

Steel tariffs to double

Trump says he will raise the duty on imports from 25% to 50%..... **A2**

Fast Ascent Of Everest Shakes Up Climbing

By KRISHNA POKHAREL AND TRIPITI LAHIRI

KATHMANDU, Nepal—Four men left London's Heathrow Airport for Nepal on a May afternoon. Within five days, they were atop Mount Everest, the 29,000-foot peak where an ascent typically takes weeks of acclimatization and bursts of climbing punctuated by rest. Instead, the British army veterans prepared using a new pre-acclimatization regime involving inhaling xenon gas—once used as an anesthetic but now more commonly found in rocket propellant.

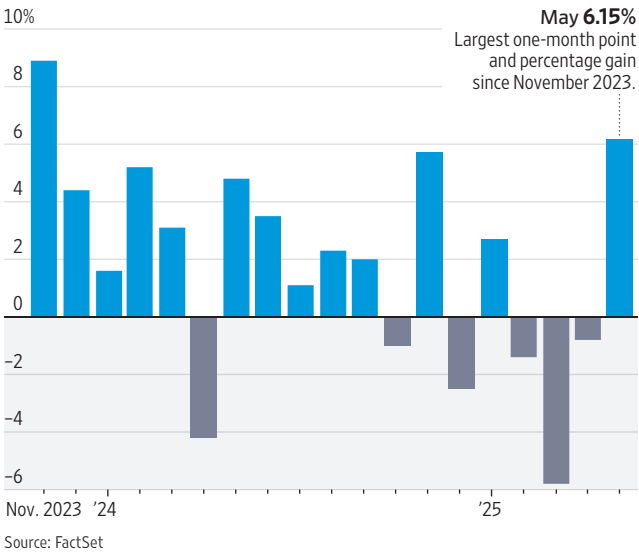
Their ascent is rocking the mountaineering community and Nepali authorities: The gas is banned from competitive sport by the World Anti-Doping Agency, provoking the criticism its use in the climb amounts to cheating. Nepal's mountaineering authorities are studying the implications. Mountain climbing is largely unregulated, though climbing Everest requires Nepal's permission if climbing from the south face, and China's if from the north face. On May 29, when the country marks the first recognized summit of the mountain in 1953 as Everest Day, Nepal's prime minister lamented the use of xenon. "Dishonesty even with Mount Everest?" Khadga Prasad Sharma Oli said. "If it did happen, it should be stopped." Alistair Carns, a climber in the group, said critics should Please turn to page A8

Stocks Post Best Month Since 2023

By JACK PITCHER

U.S. stocks delivered their best month since late 2023, powering through every twist of tariff news and an uneven corporate earnings season to leave the indexes hovering just above where they began this tumultuous year. Fears over the fallout from the continuing trade war remain just below the surface, and on Friday JPMorgan Chase's Jamie Dimon, the CEO of the largest U.S. bank, implored Washington to resolve its differences with other governments, and China in particular. "They're not scared, folks," Dimon said about China. "We have to get our act together and we have to do it very quickly." But for most of May, stock investors were learning to tune out the thrum of sound bites and instead focusing on what Wall Street views as the

S&P 500, monthly change



likely outcomes for the trade conflicts and the nation's economy: a string of bilateral deals with the U.S.'s biggest trading partners, and a still-

healthy corporate America. "Markets have already decided that the worst of the tariffs are unlikely to come to fruition and given passes to

many companies that paused guidance until the situation clarifies itself," said Steve Sosnick, chief strategist at Interactive Brokers. The S&P 500 rose more than 6% in May, putting it within 4% of a record closing high in mid-February. A hot tech sector, encouraging inflation data, and a growing consensus that the Trump administration won't follow through on its most severe tariff threats helped power the gains. The Dow Jones Industrial Average added 3.9% in May, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq Composite was 9.6% higher. Many downside risks that spooked investors earlier this year are still evident. On Friday, President Trump accused China of violating a tariff agreement, signaling that the Please turn to page A7

◆ **Why some investors are stuck on the sidelines.....** **B1**

How a Small Library in Vermont Became a Symbol of Resistance

Reality gets closer to fiction for the Haskell, star of new Louise Penny mystery

By JOE BARRETT

DERBY LINE, Vt.—The stately, stone-and-stained-glass library in this tiny border town in the rolling hills of Vermont plays a pivotal role in Canadian mystery writer Louise Penny's forthcoming novel. In the book, a shadowy cabal has hatched a plot to tap Canada's vast resources by making it the 51st state. Penny's beloved Chief Inspector Armand Gamache meets

with a U.S. contact at the Haskell Free Library and Opera House, trying to foil the plan. "When I wrote it, I thought, 'How am I going to make this believable?'" said Penny, who lives about 40 minutes from the library but spoke from her second home in London, of drafting the novel's outline three years ago. "This was before Trump and the whole thing." Today, the notion of some- Please turn to page A2

EXCHANGE



WAYMO'S WORLD

Driverless taxis are riding a classic tech growth curve. **B1**